As per the charge sheet, the JeM supreme commander in India, Ghazi Baba, was in touch with Afzal and Shaukat through satellite phone number 8821651150059 and Swiss telephone number 491722290100. Here, again, the police didn't investigate the matter any further. The charge sheet records, 'A request for obtaining the call details of the international telephone numbers and satellite phone numbers, which figured during the investigation of the case, has been made to Interpol, but the report is still awaited.' This was in May 2002. After this mention, it was never again registered in the court record or pursued by the investigating agencies. This was confirmed by Sushil Kumar, Afzal's lawyer in the Supreme Court. There is no mention of the Interpol report in the case records.' What happened to the Interpol report? Where was this international call coming from? This omission assumes significance if it is considered in the light of what Afzal had to say on these phone calls, 'If phone number records will be seen carefully the court would have come to know the phone number of STF. I was not given chance in the designated court to tell the real story,' Afzal wrote to his lawyer Kumar.

Afzal says he was under duress to make a particular kind of statement in the media and then in the confession. In a letter to Kumar, he clarifies: 'In Srinagar at Parompora police station [after he was arrested] everything of my belongings was seized and then they beat me and threatened me of dire consequences regarding my wife and family. Even my younger brother was taken in the police custody.'

The fact that he was under threat and duress, and was instructed to utter only a select few things that suited the prosecution story, to the media is clearly shown when the investigating officer of this case, Rajbir Singh, then ACP in the Special Cell, shouted at Afzal in front of the rolling cameras, when the latter said 'Geelani is innocent.' Shams Tahir Khan of *Aaj Tak* did the interview. He told the court in his submission that Singh shouted at Afzal, directing him not to say a word about Geelani. 'Rajbeer had requested us not to telecast that line spoken by accused [Afzal] about Geelani. So when the programme was telecast on 20 December this line was removed.'

Afzal made a confession on similar lines a day later on 21 December. While Geelani refused to confess, Afzal explained, 'This was first told to me by Rajbir Singh . . . if I will speak according to their wishes they will not harm my family members and also gave me false assurances that they will make my case [the case against him] weak so that after some time I will be released.'